

Harsh G. Bhundiya

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS:

Postdoctoral Research Fellow

2025 – present

University of Southern California

Department of Astronautical Engineering

EDUCATION:

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2025

Ph.D., Department of Aeronautics and Astronautics

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2022

M.S., Department of Aeronautics and Astronautics, GPA: 5.0/5.0

California Institute of Technology

2020

B.S., Mechanical Engineering with Minor in Aerospace, GPA: 4.0/4.0

AWARDS AND HONORS:

- NASA Space Technology Graduate Research Fellow, **2023-2025**
- MIT School of Engineering Communication Fellow, **2022-2025**
- MathWorks Engineering Fellow, **2022-2023**
- Tau Beta Pi Fellow, **2022-2023**

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS:

Superscript * denotes the corresponding author.

- J1. **H.G. Bhundiya***, Z.C. Cordero, and M.A. Marshall, “Passive Gravity Gradient Capture during In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing,” *AIAA Journal* (submitted).
- J2. **H.G. Bhundiya**, M.A. Marshall, and Z.C. Cordero*, “Fabrication Time Diagrams for In-Space Manufacturing of Large Reticulated Structures,” *Journal of Manufacturing Science and Engineering*, 146(12), 2024. [DOI](#)
- J3. J.Z. Zhang, **H.G. Bhundiya**, K.D. Overby, F. Royer, J.H. Lang, Z.C. Cordero*, W.F. Moulder, S.K. Jeon, and M.J. Silver, “Electrostatically Actuated X-Band Mesh Reflector with Bend-Formed Support Structure,” *Journal of Spacecraft and Rockets*, 61(6), 2024. [DOI](#)
- J4. **H.G. Bhundiya**, Z.C. Cordero*, “Bend-Forming: A CNC Deformation Process for Fabricating 3D Wireframe Structures,” *Additive Manufacturing Letters*, 6, 2023. [DOI](#)
- J5. **H.G. Bhundiya**, F. Royer, and Z. Cordero*, “Engineering Framework for Assessing Materials and Processes for In-Space Manufacturing,” *Journal of Materials Engineering and Performance*, 31(2), 2022. [DOI](#)

CONFERENCE PRECEEDINGS:

- C1. **H.G. Bhundiya**, Z.C. Cordero, M.A. Marshall, “Passive Gravity Gradient Capture for In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing,” AIAA/AAS Astrodynamics Specialist Conference (Boston, MA), Aug 2025.
- C2. **H.G. Bhundiya**, Z.C. Cordero, “Radially Expanding Euler Paths for Assembly of Truss Structures,” International Symposium on Space Technology and Science (Tokushima, Japan), Jul 2025.
- C3. **H.G. Bhundiya**, Z.C. Cordero, M.A. Marshall, S. Mohan, D. Sternberg, and K. Lo, “Ground Testing of Spacecraft Attitude Dynamics During In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing,” AIAA Scitech Forum (Orlando, FL), Jan 2025. [DOI](#)

- C4. **H.G. Bhundiya**, J.Z. Zhang, K.D. Overby, F. Royer, J.H. Lang, Z.C. Cordero, W.F. Moulder, S.K. Jeon, and M.J. Silver, “Electrostatically Actuated X-Band Mesh Reflector with Bend-Formed Support Structure,” AIAA Scitech Forum (National Harbor, MD), Jan 2023. [DOI](#)
- C5. F. Royer, J.Z. Zhang, K.D. Overby, E.Y. Zhu, **H.G. Bhundiya**, J.H. Lang, and Z.C. Cordero, “Electrostatically Actuated Thin-Shell Space Structures,” AIAA Scitech Forum (National Harbor, MD), Jan 2023. [DOI](#)
- C6. (*Awarded 2022 AIAA Spacecraft Structures Best Paper*) **H.G. Bhundiya**, F. Royer, and Z. Cordero, “Compressive Behavior of Isogrid Columns Fabricated with Bend-Forming,” AIAA SciTech Forum (San Diego, CA), Jan 2022. [DOI](#)
- C7. **H.G. Bhundiya**, M. Hunt, and B. Drolen, “Measurement of the Effective Radial Thermal Conductivities of 18650 and 26650 Lithium-Ion Battery Cells,” NASA Thermal and Fluid Analysis Workshop (Galveston, TX), Aug 2018. [DOI](#)

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY:

- P1. **H.G. Bhundiya**, Z.C. Cordero, “Computer Numerical Control (CNC) Deformation Process for Forming 3D Wireframe Structures.” US Patent Application No. 18/147,674, Dec 2022.

INVITED TALKS:

- T1. The Aerospace Corporation, “Rapid In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing of Next-Generation Space Structures,” Los Angeles, CA, Dec 2025.
- T2. California Institute of Technology, ME10 Class Guest Lecture, “Constructing Large Structures in Space,” Pasadena, CA, Nov 2025
- T3. NASA Langley Research Center, “Rapid In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing of Next-Generation Space Structures,” Hampton, VA, Aug 2025.
- T4. Johns Hopkins University Applied Physics Laboratory, “Rapid In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing of Next-Generation Space Structures,” Laurel, MD, Jul 2025.
- T5. NASA Goddard Spaceflight Center, “Rapid In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing of Next-Generation Space Structures,” Greenbelt, MD, Jul 2025.
- T6. AIAA Emerging Spacecraft Structures Technology Workshop, “Passive Gravity Gradient Capture for In-Space Assembly and Manufacturing,” Boulder, CO, Jun 2025.
- T7. MIT Small Satellite Collaborative Seminar, “Fabrication Time Diagrams for In-Space Manufacturing of Reticulated Structures,” Boston, MA. Oct 2024.
- T8. AIAA Emerging Spacecraft Structures Technology Workshop, “Fabrication Time Diagrams for In-Space Manufacturing of Reticulated Structures,” Boston, MA. Jul 2024.
- T9. Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar, “In-Space Manufacturing of Large Electrostatically-Actuated Mesh Reflectors,” Gujarat, India, Jan 2024.
- T10. AIAA Emerging Spacecraft Structures Technology Workshop, “Spacecraft Dynamics during In-Space Manufacturing,” Stanford, CA, Aug 2023.
- T11. U.S. National Congress of Computational Mechanics, “Bend-Forming: A CNC Deformation Process for Fabricating 3D Wireframe Structures,” Albuquerque, NM, Jul 2023.
- T12. AFRL Space Vehicles Directorate, “In-Space Manufacturing of Large Electrostatically-Actuated Mesh Reflectors,” Albuquerque, NM, Jul 2023.

MENTORING AND ADVISING:

Masters Researchers:

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| • Arad Firouzkouhi | USC Astro | Fall 2025 – present |
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Undergraduate Researchers:

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| • Atharva Shah | MIT AeroAstro | Fall 2024 – Summer 2025 |
| • Elizabeth Zhu | MIT AeroAstro | Summer 2022 – Fall 2022 |

- Jack Ansley MIT AeroAstro Spring 2022 – Summer 2022
- Brennan Hoppa MIT AeroAstro Spring 2022 – Summer 2022

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE:

- **Technical Manuscript Reviewer:** Acta Astronautica, Journal of Spacecraft and Rockets, AIAA Scitech Forum
- **Member:** American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics (AIAA) Spacecraft Structures Technical Committee

TEACHING EXPERIENCE:

California Institute of Technology

Department of Mechanical Engineering

2019 ME 11 Thermodynamics, Fluid Dynamics (*Teaching Assistant*)

2019-2020 ME 12 Statics, Dynamics, Mechanics of Materials (*Teaching Assistant*)

OUTREACH ACTIVITIES:

- **Educational Blogger**, maintains an educational blog titled “Harsh World of Mechanics” focused on everyday applications of mechanics of materials and structures (2021-present)
- **Lecturer**, Cambridge Science Festival (2023). Gave a lecture titled “Manufacturing Large Structures in Space” at the Cambridge Science Festival hosted by the MIT Museum.
- **Instructor**, MIT Educational Studies Program (2022-2024). Taught a biannual class on “Geometry and Beauty of Soap Bubbles” to >100 middle school and high school students.